



Q

What is the recommended dehydrator temperature to dry fruit leathers safely at home?



ANSWER

Maintain dehydrator air temperature steadily at 140°F

FUN FACT

Keeping a steady 140°F ensures fruit leather dries evenly without cooking.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What must be done to homemade jerky after dehydrating to ensure it is safe to eat?



ANSWER

Heat in a preheated 275°F oven for 10 minutes

FUN FACT

Post-drying heating kills pathogens that low drying temperatures cannot destroy.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Why is it important to form a pellicle on fish before hot smoking?



ANSWER

It helps smoke deposit evenly and prevents surface spoilage

FUN FACT

The pellicle is slightly tacky and shiny, perfect for smoke adhesion.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Which internal temperature must be reached and held for smoked fish to ensure safety?



ANSWER

150°F (preferably 160°F) for at least 30 minutes

FUN FACT

Sufficient heat during smoking kills harmful bacteria like Clostridium botulinum.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What is a safe salt concentration for fish brine used before smoking?



ANSWER

One part table salt to seven parts water by volume

FUN FACT

This 1:7 salt-to-water ratio creates about 60° SAL on a salometer scale.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What is the main purpose of drying food during home preservation?



ANSWER

Removing moisture prevents microorganisms from growing

FUN FACT

Drying is the oldest known method of food preservation.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Why should you not alter a tested home drying recipe by changing ingredient ratios?



ANSWER

Recipe safety and effectiveness depend on precise ingredient quantities

FUN FACT

Small changes in curing salts or brine can cause unsafe finished products.

Source: PNW 784 Making bacon at home



Q

How long should fruit leather be dried at 140°F before removing it from the dehydrator?



ANSWER

About 10 hours until no sticky areas remain

FUN FACT

Testing dryness by touch ensures leathers aren't over- or under-dried.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What is the recommended storage condition for homemade dried jerky?



ANSWER

Store in airtight containers in a cool, dry place

FUN FACT

Proper storage prevents moisture reabsorption which can lead to spoilage.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

How should fish be cut before brining for smoking?



ANSWER

Pieces of uniform size and thickness

FUN FACT

Uniform size ensures consistent salt uptake and cooking.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What safety issue is especially significant when using ground meat to make jerky?



ANSWER

Grinding distributes surface pathogens throughout the meat

FUN FACT

Ground meats pose higher risks because bacteria from the surface mix inside.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What is an important step after curing pork belly when making bacon at home?



ANSWER

Rinse with cold water to remove excess salt and brine

FUN FACT

Rinsing removes surface salt to avoid overly salty bacon.

Source: PNW 784 Making bacon at home



Q

What happens if smoked fish is not salted or cooked properly before storage?



ANSWER

**Harmful bacteria like
Clostridium botulinum may
grow**

FUN FACT

*Proper salting and cooking ensure the
smoked fish is safe to eat.*

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

During drying, what food condition indicates fruit leather is fully dried and ready to remove from the dehydrator?



ANSWER

No indentation should be evident when gently touched

FUN FACT

Testing by touch avoids over-drying and cracking of fruit leather.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What is the effect of using low-temperature drying (about 140°F to 155°F) alone on jerky safety?



ANSWER

It does not reliably destroy pathogens in the meat

FUN FACT

Low-temperature drying creates an environment where bacteria can survive unless further steps are taken.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What is the recommended moisture level of smoked fish to safely store it under refrigeration?



ANSWER

Fish must be properly salted and cooked, then kept below 38°F

FUN FACT

Refrigeration combined with salt and heat inhibits foodborne bacteria.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

How long should fish be brined in a 1:7 salt-to-water solution before smoking?



ANSWER

1 hour for most fish, shorter for low-fat or skinned fish

FUN FACT

Brining time depends on fish size and fat content to ensure uniform salt absorption.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What must be avoided when drying fruit and vegetables at home to ensure best quality?



ANSWER

Avoid overlapping pieces on drying trays

FUN FACT

Proper spacing improves air circulation and uniform drying.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

Why is conditioning important after drying jerky before packaging?



ANSWER

It equilibrates the moisture within the jerky to prevent mold

FUN FACT

Conditioning involves storing jerky loosely in a container for several days to spread moisture evenly.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Which curing salt is commonly used in home bacon curing recipes for safe preservation?



ANSWER

Curing Salt #1 (Prague Powder #1)

FUN FACT

Curing salts contain nitrites that prevent bacterial growth and preserve color.

Source: PNW 784 Making bacon at home